

6. Tenses

Introduction and Definition

Tense is the form of a verb that shows the time of an action or state. It tells whether an action happens in the present, past, or future. Correct use of tense makes sentences clear and meaningful. English grammar has three main tenses. Each tense has different forms to express time and continuity.

She writes neatly in her notebook.

They are playing in the ground.

He has finished his homework.

We watched the match yesterday.

I will visit my grandparents tomorrow.

Verb Forms

Verb forms change according to tense and subject. They show whether an action is happening now, happened before, or will happen later. The base form, past form, and past participle are commonly used. Regular verbs follow fixed patterns while irregular verbs do not. Correct verb forms are essential for grammatical accuracy.

She speaks English fluently.

He spoke politely to the teacher.

They have eaten lunch.

The bell rang suddenly.

I will write the letter.

Helping Verbs

Helping verbs support the main verb to form tense and meaning. They help to show time, continuity, and completion of actions. Common helping verbs are is, am, are, was, were, has, have, and will.

She is reading a story.

They were waiting for the bus.

He has completed the work.

We are learning grammar.

I will help you.

Present Tense

The present tense is used to describe actions related to time. It has four forms to show different aspects. Each form has a specific use. Correct understanding



improves sentence construction. This tense is important for examinations.

She reads every day.

They are watching television.

He has lost his keys.

We have been studying since morning.

The sun rises in the east.

Present Indefinite

The present indefinite tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She reads the newspaper daily.

He plays cricket after school.

They like ice cream.

The train arrives on time.

Birds fly in the sky.

Present Continuous

The present continuous tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She is cooking food.

They are studying for the test.

I am writing a letter.

He is watching a movie.

We are waiting for the teacher.

Present Perfect

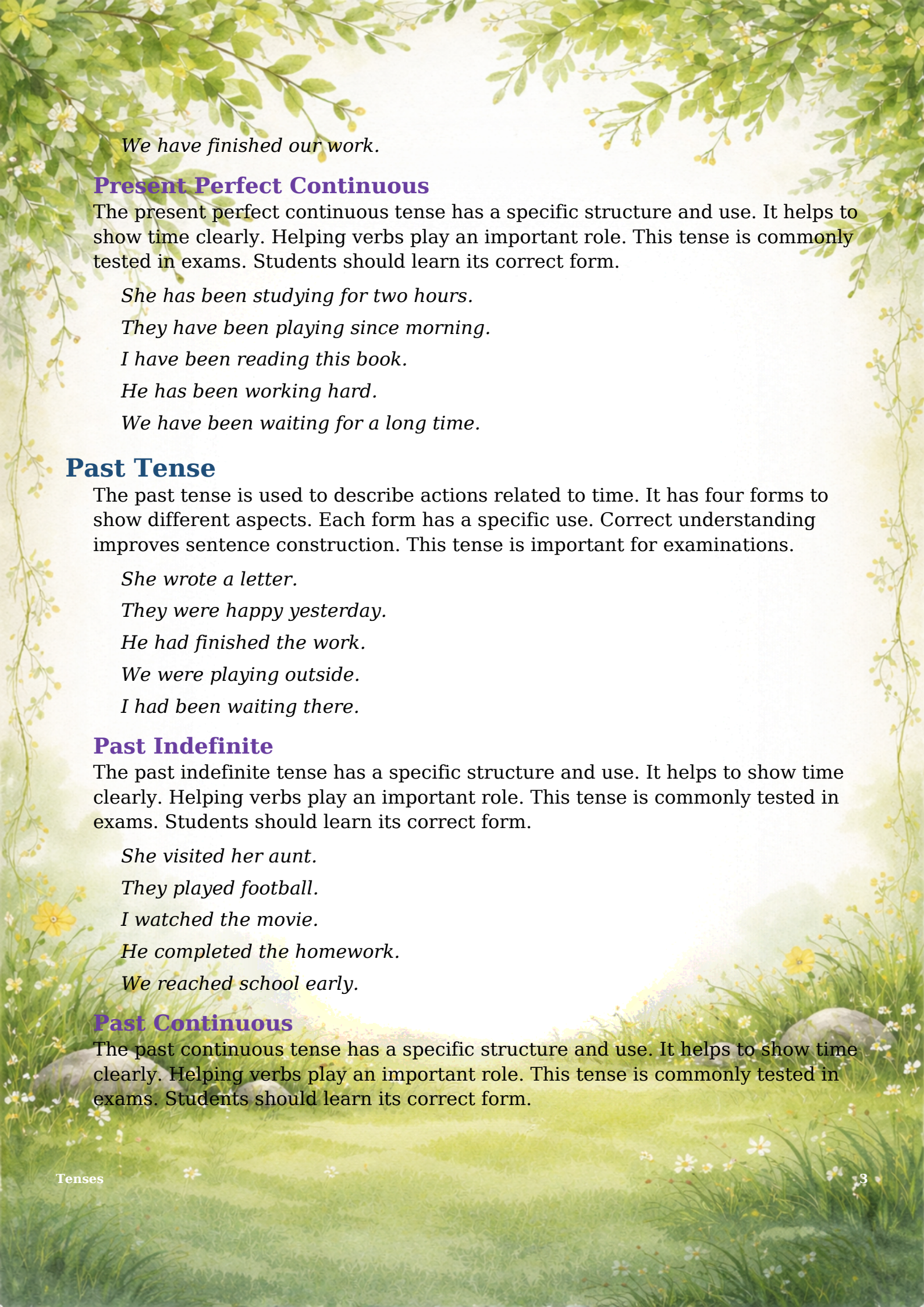
The present perfect tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She has completed the project.

They have visited Delhi.

I have lost my pen.

He has won the prize.



We have finished our work.

Present Perfect Continuous

The present perfect continuous tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She has been studying for two hours.

They have been playing since morning.

I have been reading this book.

He has been working hard.

We have been waiting for a long time.

Past Tense

The past tense is used to describe actions related to time. It has four forms to show different aspects. Each form has a specific use. Correct understanding improves sentence construction. This tense is important for examinations.

She wrote a letter.

They were happy yesterday.

He had finished the work.

We were playing outside.

I had been waiting there.

Past Indefinite

The past indefinite tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She visited her aunt.

They played football.

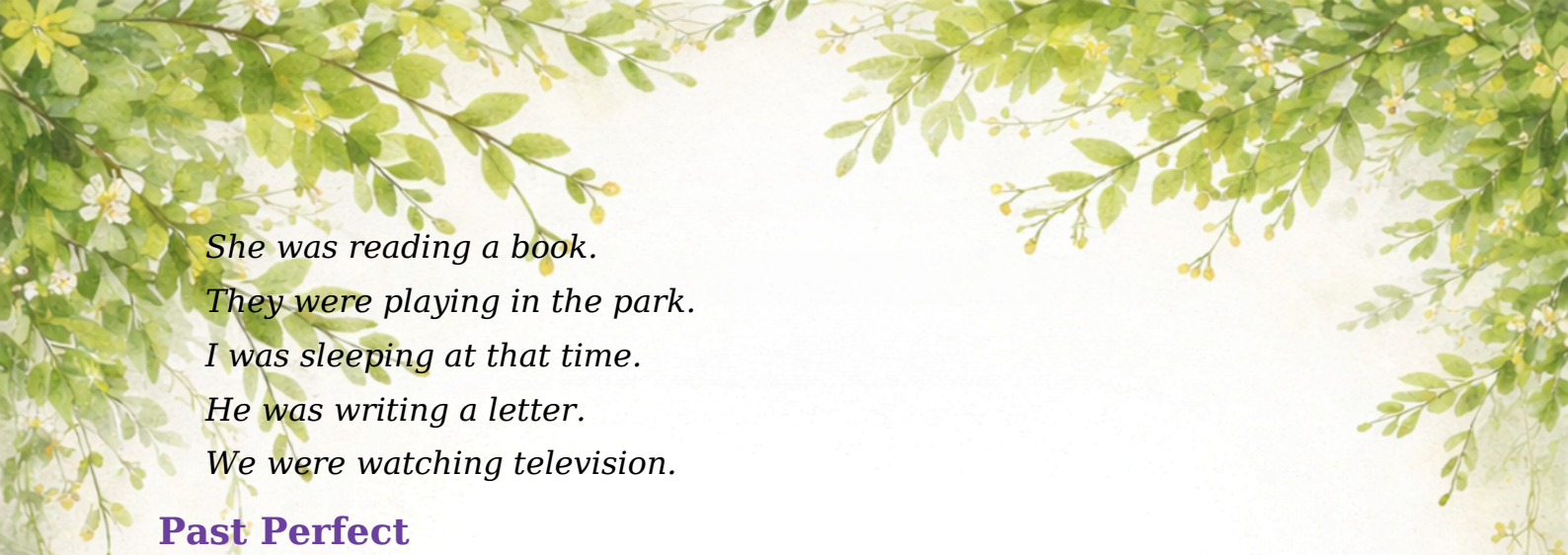
I watched the movie.

He completed the homework.

We reached school early.

Past Continuous

The past continuous tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.



She was reading a book.
They were playing in the park.
I was sleeping at that time.
He was writing a letter.
We were watching television.

Past Perfect

The past perfect tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She had finished her work.
They had left before we arrived.
I had completed the task.
He had eaten food.
We had reached the station.

Past Perfect Continuous

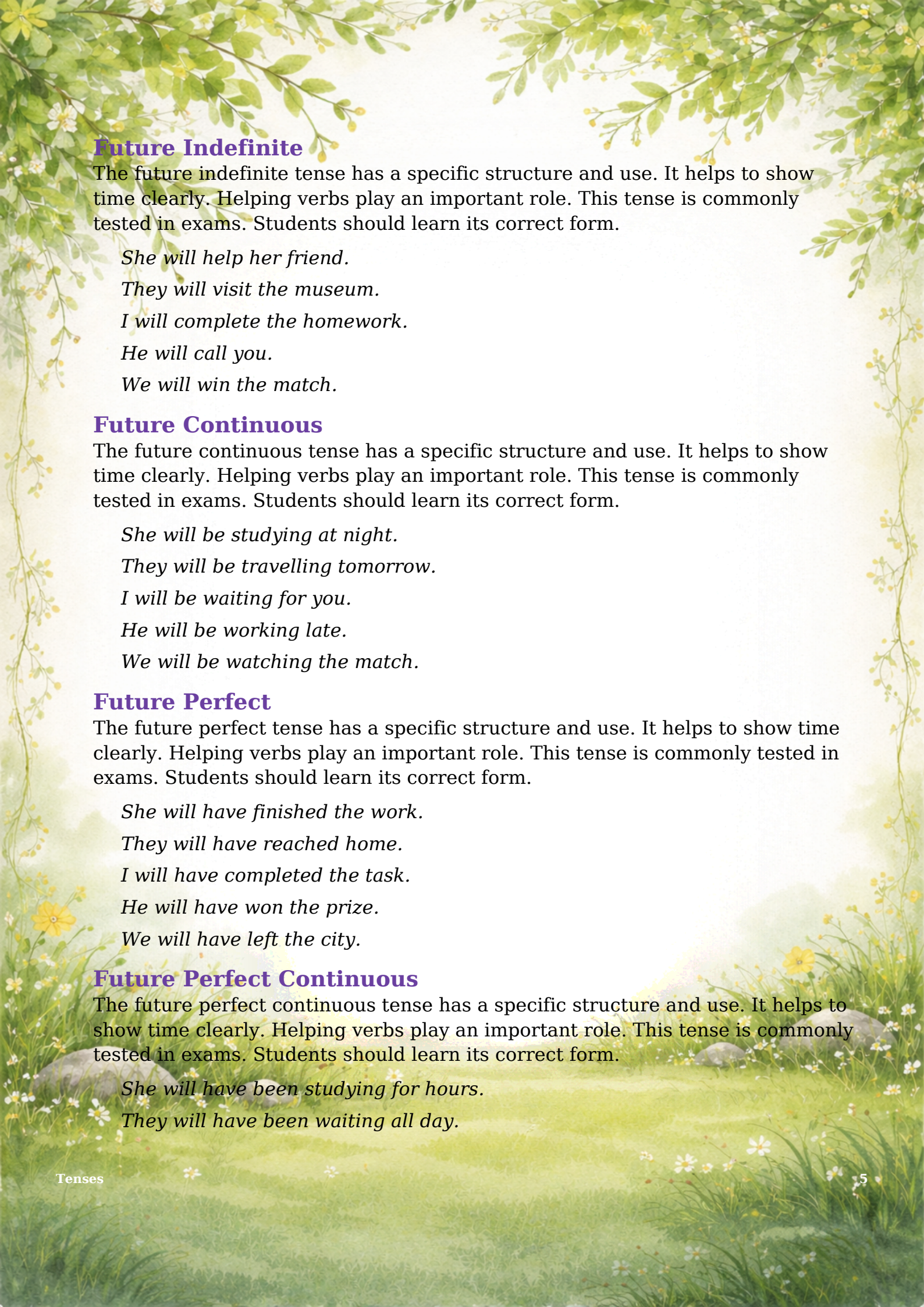
The past perfect continuous tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She had been studying for hours.
They had been waiting since morning.
I had been working all day.
He had been playing football.
We had been living there for years.

Future Tense

The future tense is used to describe actions related to time. It has four forms to show different aspects. Each form has a specific use. Correct understanding improves sentence construction. This tense is important for examinations.

She will attend the meeting.
They will travel tomorrow.
I will be studying later.
He will have completed the work.
We will have been waiting.



Future Indefinite

The future indefinite tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She will help her friend.

They will visit the museum.

I will complete the homework.

He will call you.

We will win the match.

Future Continuous

The future continuous tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She will be studying at night.

They will be travelling tomorrow.

I will be waiting for you.

He will be working late.

We will be watching the match.

Future Perfect

The future perfect tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She will have finished the work.

They will have reached home.

I will have completed the task.

He will have won the prize.

We will have left the city.

Future Perfect Continuous

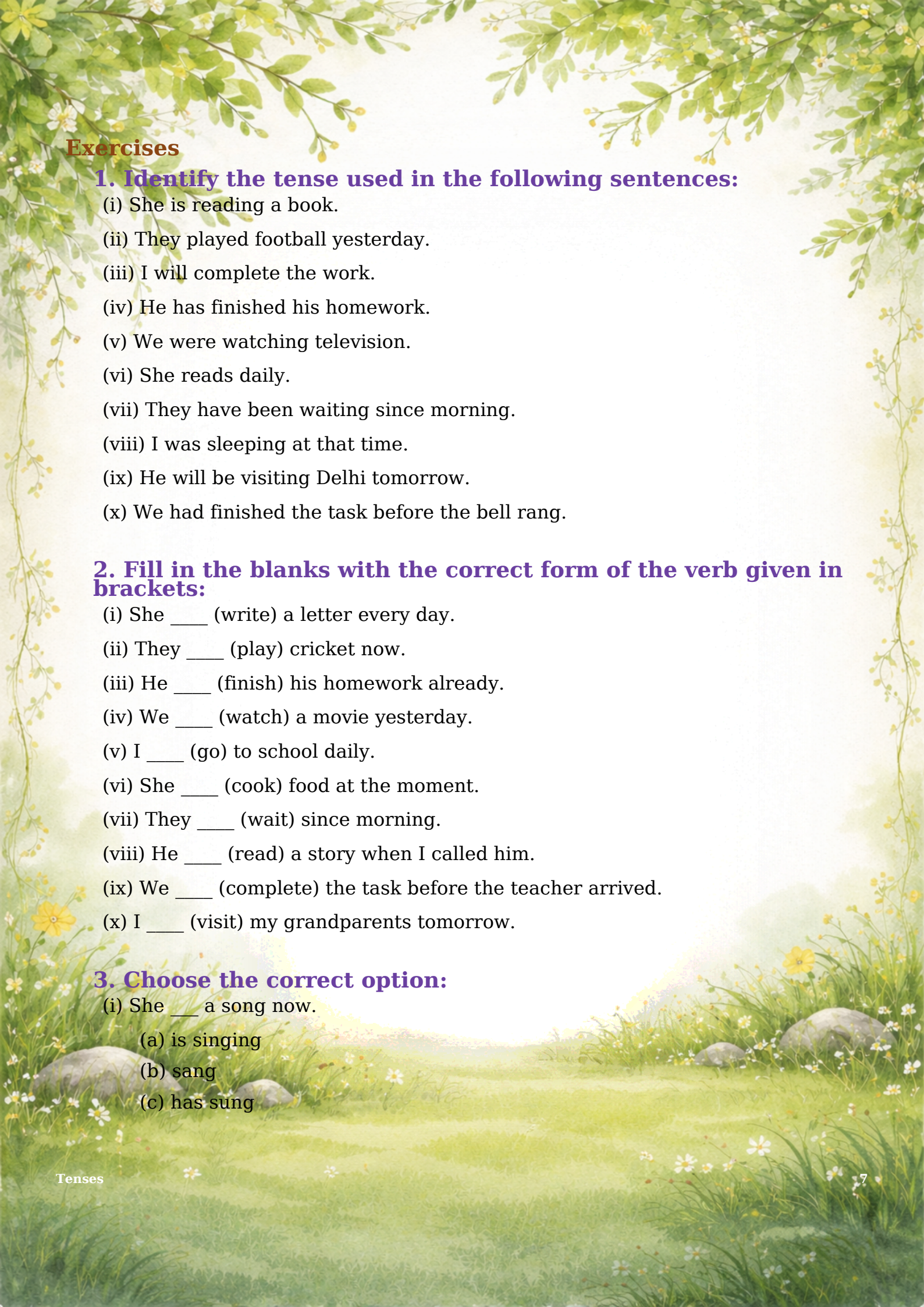
The future perfect continuous tense has a specific structure and use. It helps to show time clearly. Helping verbs play an important role. This tense is commonly tested in exams. Students should learn its correct form.

She will have been studying for hours.

They will have been waiting all day.



*I will have been working since morning.
He will have been playing for two hours.
We will have been living here for years.*



Exercises

1. Identify the tense used in the following sentences:

- (i) She is reading a book.
- (ii) They played football yesterday.
- (iii) I will complete the work.
- (iv) He has finished his homework.
- (v) We were watching television.
- (vi) She reads daily.
- (vii) They have been waiting since morning.
- (viii) I was sleeping at that time.
- (ix) He will be visiting Delhi tomorrow.
- (x) We had finished the task before the bell rang.

2. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb given in brackets:

- (i) She ____ (write) a letter every day.
- (ii) They ____ (play) cricket now.
- (iii) He ____ (finish) his homework already.
- (iv) We ____ (watch) a movie yesterday.
- (v) I ____ (go) to school daily.
- (vi) She ____ (cook) food at the moment.
- (vii) They ____ (wait) since morning.
- (viii) He ____ (read) a story when I called him.
- (ix) We ____ (complete) the task before the teacher arrived.
- (x) I ____ (visit) my grandparents tomorrow.

3. Choose the correct option:

- (i) She ____ a song now.
 - (a) is singing
 - (b) sang
 - (c) has sung

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- (d) will sing
- (ii) They ___ football yesterday.
- (a) play
- (b) played
- (c) are playing
- (d) will play
- (iii) He ___ his homework already.
- (a) finishes
- (b) has finished
- (c) is finishing
- (d) will finish
- (iv) I ___ to school daily.
- (a) go
- (b) went
- (c) gone
- (d) going
- (v) We ___ TV when it started raining.
- (a) watch
- (b) were watching
- (c) watched
- (d) will watch
- (vi) She ___ her grandparents tomorrow.
- (a) visits
- (b) visited
- (c) will visit
- (d) has visited
- (vii) They ___ since morning.
- (a) wait
- (b) have been waiting
- (c) waited
- (d) are waiting
- (viii) He ___ the prize recently.

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- (a) wins
 - (b) won
 - (c) has won
 - (d) will win

4. Match the following:

List A

- 1. Present Indefinite
- 2. Present Continuous
- 3. Past Indefinite
- 4. Future Indefinite
- 5. Present Perfect

List B

- A. Habitual action
- B. Action happening now
- C. Completed action in the past
- D. Action yet to happen
- E. Recently completed action

5. Identify the type of tense used:

- (i) She reads the newspaper daily.
- (ii) They are playing in the park.
- (iii) He has completed the work.
- (iv) We watched a movie yesterday.
- (v) I will visit Delhi tomorrow.
- (vi) She was reading when I entered.
- (vii) They had finished before we arrived.
- (viii) We have been waiting for an hour.
- (ix) He will be studying at 8 p.m.
- (x) She will have finished the project by Monday.

6. Multiple choice questions:

- (i) By the time you reach, I ____ the work.
 - (a) will finish
 - (b) will have finished
 - (c) finish
 - (d) have finished
- (ii) Look! The baby ____.

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- (a) cries
(b) is crying
(c) cried
(d) has cried
- (iii) They ___ in this city since 2015.
(a) live
(b) lived
(c) have been living
(d) will live
- (iv) He ___ breakfast when the phone rang.
(a) has
(b) was having
(c) had
(d) will have
- (v) She ___ to Jaipur last year.
(a) goes
(b) went
(c) has gone
(d) will go
- (vi) We ___ the match tomorrow.
(a) watch
(b) watched
(c) will watch
(d) are watching
- (vii) The train ___ at 6 a.m. every day.
(a) arrives
(b) arrived
(c) will arrive
(d) has arrived
- (viii) He ___ the letter before he left.
(a) writes
(b) wrote

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- (c) had written
(d) has written
- (ix) I ____ my homework right now.
(a) do
(b) am doing
(c) did
(d) have done
- (x) Next week, they ____ for three months.
(a) will stay
(b) will be staying
(c) will have stayed
(d) stay

7. Spot the error in the following sentences and correct it:

- (i) She go to school daily.
(ii) They was playing in the ground.
(iii) He have finished his homework.
(iv) We is watching television now.
(v) I will going to Delhi tomorrow.
(vi) She were reading a book.
(vii) They has been waiting since morning.
(viii) He do his work carefully.
(ix) We was happy yesterday.
(x) I has completed the task.

8. Correct the following paragraph:

Yesterday I go to school early. The bell ring before I reach. All students sit in the class. The teacher enter the room. She ask us questions. We answer carefully. Some students was nervous. Others do not listen. The teacher explain the lesson. She write on the board. We copy the notes. After that she give homework. I do not understand one question. My friend help me. The class end soon. We pack our bags. The bell ring again. We leave the classroom. I go home



happily. I think about the lesson.



Answer Sheet

1. Identify the tense:

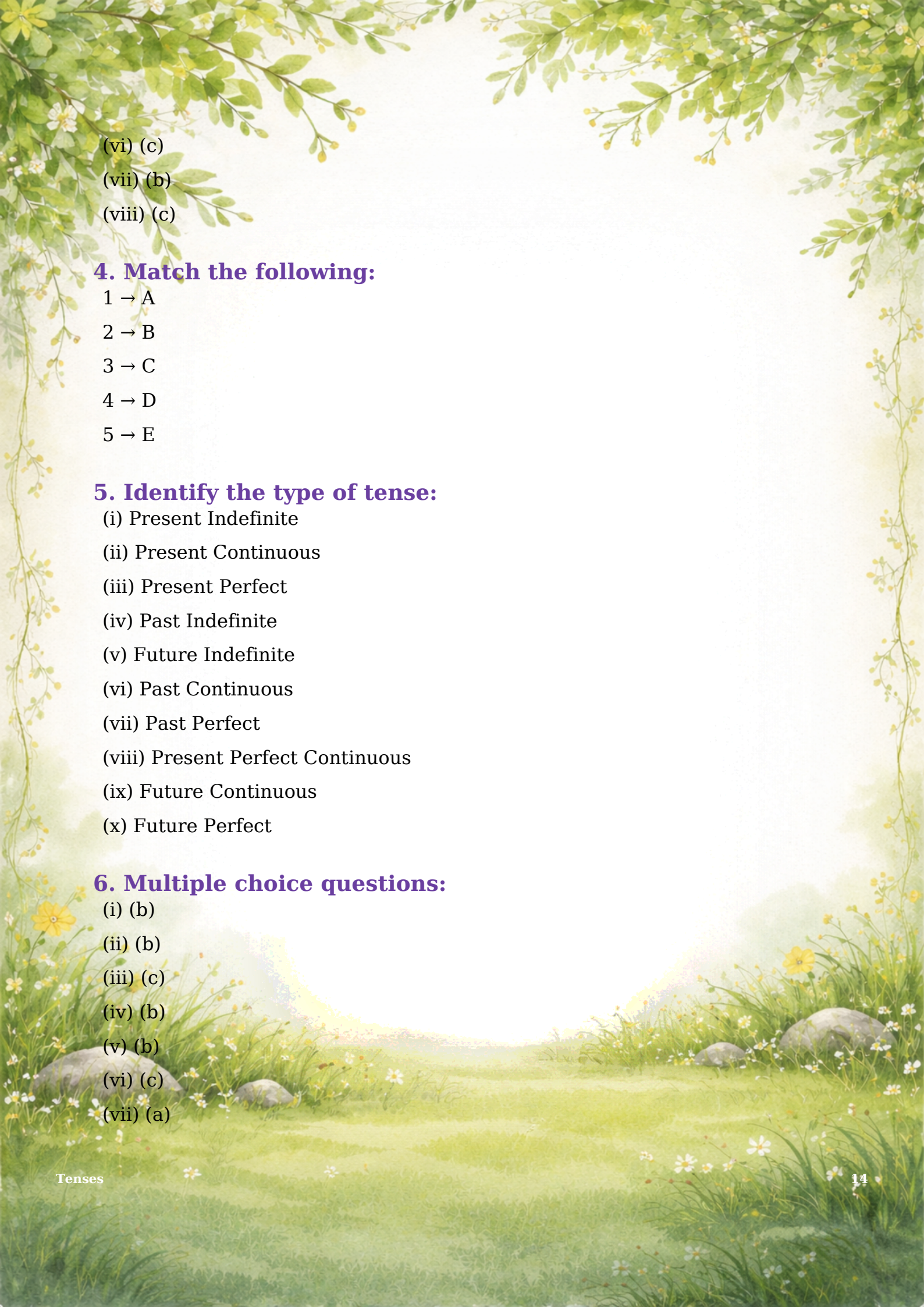
- (i) Present Continuous
- (ii) Past Indefinite
- (iii) Future Indefinite
- (iv) Present Perfect
- (v) Past Continuous
- (vi) Present Indefinite
- (vii) Present Perfect Continuous
- (viii) Past Continuous
- (ix) Future Continuous
- (x) Past Perfect

2. Fill in the blanks:

- (i) writes
- (ii) are playing
- (iii) has finished
- (iv) watched
- (v) go
- (vi) is cooking
- (vii) have been waiting
- (viii) was reading
- (ix) had completed
- (x) will visit

3. Choose the correct option:

- (i) (a)
- (ii) (b)
- (iii) (b)
- (iv) (a)
- (v) (b)

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- (vi) (c)
(vii) (b)
(viii) (c)

4. Match the following:

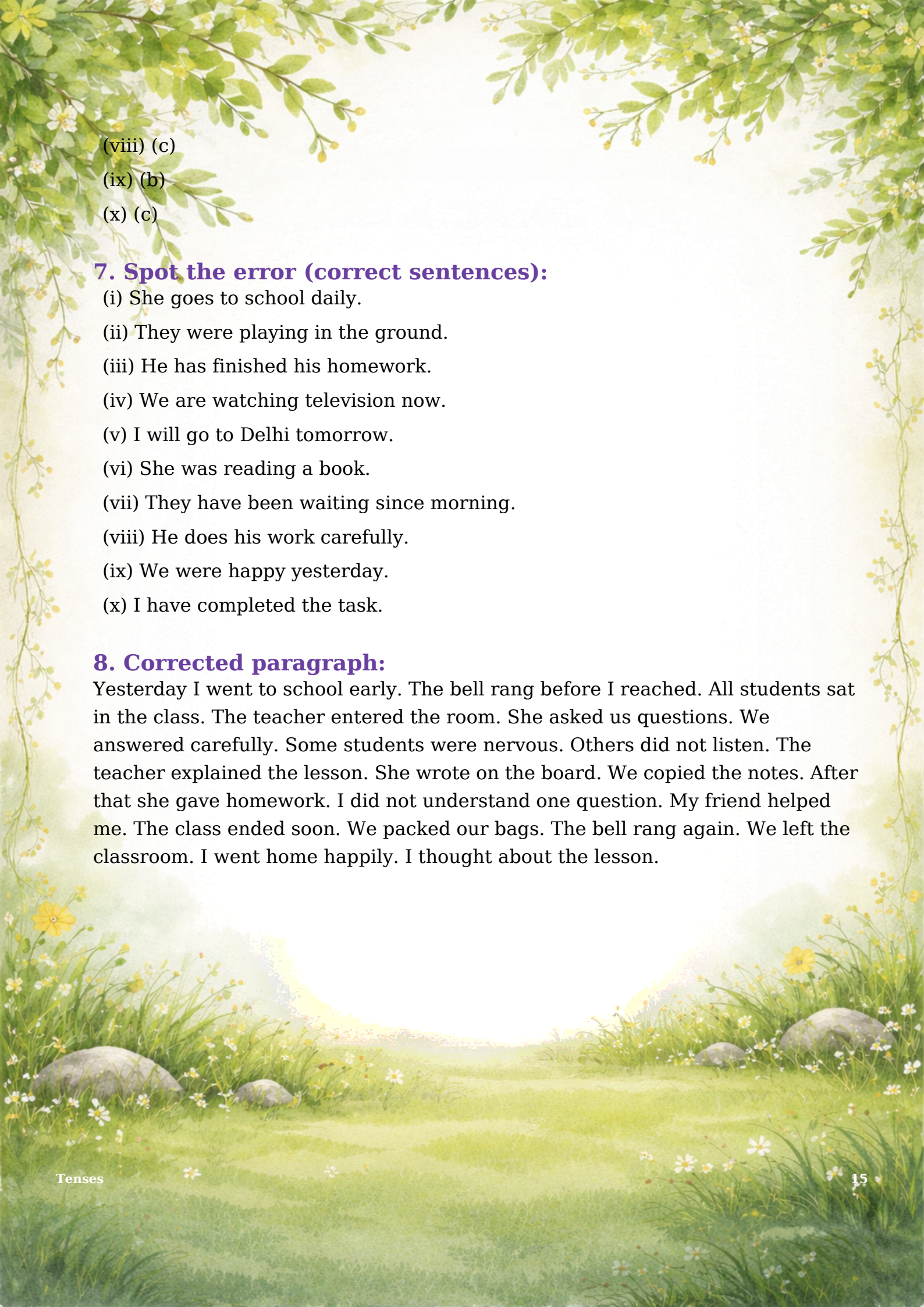
- 1 → A
2 → B
3 → C
4 → D
5 → E

5. Identify the type of tense:

- (i) Present Indefinite
(ii) Present Continuous
(iii) Present Perfect
(iv) Past Indefinite
(v) Future Indefinite
(vi) Past Continuous
(vii) Past Perfect
(viii) Present Perfect Continuous
(ix) Future Continuous
(x) Future Perfect

6. Multiple choice questions:

- (i) (b)
(ii) (b)
(iii) (c)
(iv) (b)
(v) (b)
(vi) (c)
(vii) (a)



(viii) (c)

(ix) (b)

(x) (c)

7. Spot the error (correct sentences):

- (i) She goes to school daily.
- (ii) They were playing in the ground.
- (iii) He has finished his homework.
- (iv) We are watching television now.
- (v) I will go to Delhi tomorrow.
- (vi) She was reading a book.
- (vii) They have been waiting since morning.
- (viii) He does his work carefully.
- (ix) We were happy yesterday.
- (x) I have completed the task.

8. Corrected paragraph:

Yesterday I went to school early. The bell rang before I reached. All students sat in the class. The teacher entered the room. She asked us questions. We answered carefully. Some students were nervous. Others did not listen. The teacher explained the lesson. She wrote on the board. We copied the notes. After that she gave homework. I did not understand one question. My friend helped me. The class ended soon. We packed our bags. The bell rang again. We left the classroom. I went home happily. I thought about the lesson.